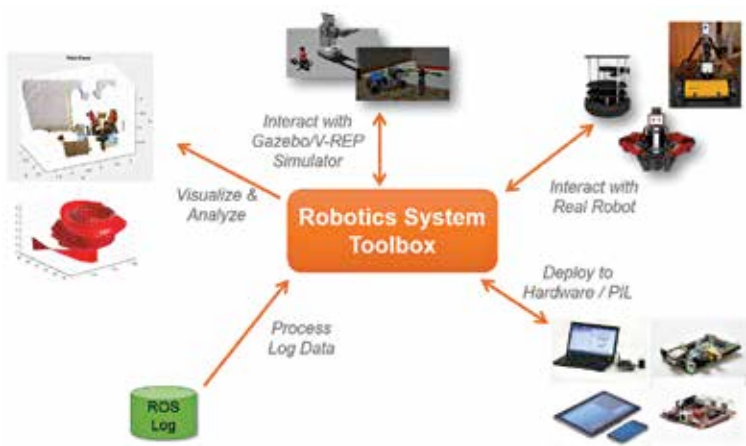




How ROS works

munity takes time, but once you have one, it's like shifting gears. Because it relied on a (expensive) paid fee, URBI was unable to establish a community. As a result, only those who could afford it had access to the framework. As a result, the quantity of community you may build is limited. True, ROS was available for free. That, however, is not the case (many products that are free fail). The reason for this is that they established a community. Being self-sufficient was simply a tactic for forming that community.

Getting Funded

Keenan and Eric acquired \$50,000 in financing while at Stanford and utilised it to develop a PR robot and a demo of their actual project. However, they realised that they would need additional financing to establish a really universal system and provide those robots to the research groups. As a result, they began pitching to investors.

Keenan and Eric met with Scott Hassan, an investor and the creator of Willow Garage, a research facility focused on robotics technologies, sometime around 2008. Scott was so taken with their concept that he decided to fund it and collaborate with them to launch a Personal Robotics Program at Willow Garage. The PR2 robot, as well as the Robot Operating System, was born. In fact, the ROS project grew so vital that Willow Garage abandoned all of its previous initiatives and focused only on the development and distribution of ROS.